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Love and War

Love is desired by many but attained by a few. *SOMEBODY*, by Keshi, perfectly illustrates his fear of love and commitment in a relationship. The song shares an essential chapter of his personal life and diverts from his typical musical style. Compared to his previous music videos which portrayed his depressed and vulnerable side, this depicts an emotionless “player” side of him. Keshi himself is the “*SOMEBODY*” that he talks about throughout his song. Throughout the music video, Keshi utilizes symbolism and literary devices in the lyrics to evoke emotions in the audience and express his transformed cold-blooded self.

This music video is set in an antique-filled mansion with distorted furniture, fallen chandeliers, and broken curtains, all of which symbolize the mental disorder Keshi has developed through all of his failed relationships. A girl dressed in a minimal black outfit walks towards a row of antique televisions, which shows the mental problems such as commitment issues developed throughout her relationship with her. The romantic and sweet sounds of acoustic guitar fill the background of the song as he sings passionate lyrics about indulging in physical intimacy. Throughout the entirety of the music video, there are three women. The women dressed in black are dancing while expressing their sexuality and lip-syncing the lyrics, while there is a woman on the floor almost crying to the lyrics. These women represent Keshi's feelings and what he's been through after the breakups. Keshi says “Go another round, make the bedrock, Yuh, bite the neck, I'ma make it sweat. Never give you no rest, never give you any rest” (Keshi, *Somebody*). He is expressing his feelings for this girl whom he is having a one-night

stand with. When Keshi says “I can be that body.” (Keshi, Somebody). These bold lyrics capture the heated fantasy of exploring his partner’s body as he sings lines like “never give you any rest” and “show me your favorite spots, but you don’t gotta say it.” (Keshi, Somebody) The tension rises throughout the music video, with scenes of women expressing their sexuality.

Throughout this music video, its impressions are dark. The scene where he sits in the pit of fog and flowers symbolizes death because the thick fog and flowers resemble a graveyard. The room with white sheets, curtains, and furniture has a female in black sitting on the white bed could represent impure things happening on that bed because white is considered a pure color it contradicts the whole theme of one-night stands because white is pure. Since 1566, White has been a true balance of all colors. It’s associated with cleanliness, simplicity, and perfection. At the end of the music video, Keshi is standing in a room and as he is saying “Pull me close, Pull me close, Hold me tight” the camera slowly zooms towards him this symbolizes that though he’s been through hell and back with relationships, he still craves for that love and touch from his significant other.

The dark lighting, heavy thunderstorms, and the sad girl crying while singing the lyrics help shape the sadness and darkness emotion of the music video. While the two girls are dancing and expressing their sexuality, one of the girls in that music video was crying. This heavily relates to the way he felt after the fallout in his relationships. The sad and lonely girl crying in the corner resembles Keshi’s sad and lonely self after the breakups. The two girls dancing and expressing their sexuality represent Keshi’s growth. After having been through hell and back he gained his confidence and became stronger where he grew to love himself. Regardless of failed relationships or bad breakups he still wants to be loved and cared for, as all humans do, So at the end of the music video, he says “ pull me close, hold me tight” (Keshi,

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uV2yMgh85qU>) the camera moves closer to him symbolizing his desire to be loved even though he has been through bad relationships.

The dark theme, lightning thunder, and beautiful mansion all of these tell a story of life. To be specific, Keshi's life. The dark theme could be about his mindset and emotions because he was miserable when someone he thought to be the love of his life left him. This work of art reflects the view of romantic relationships in today's society. The hookup culture has been extremely normalized to the point where when a couple falls out of their relationship they go through a phase known as the "hoe phase" during this phase a phase in their life where they will sleep with as many people as they please, to try and put a bandaid to the cut that their old relationship left on them.

Love is desired by many but attained by a few. While having been through the worst breaks up's and relationships Keshi still desires to be loved which he represents towards the end of the music video. By having the camera zoom in on him as he said "Pull me close, hold me tight" he is saying that he wants to be loved and held. This work of art is beautiful as it represents the artist's feelings through the music video. He is expressing his sexual desires for women, but deep inside he is trying to get love without being attached and needy of love, which has left him helpless in the past. Throughout this music video, many symbolic meanings are left to be interpreted by the viewers. For example, the girl in black sitting on a white esthetic bed could be a reference to the women he has met in the past as their impure hearts and intentions have left him completely helpless and by himself. He is weary and afraid to truly love someone yet, wants to be loved and held.

Work cited page:

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